

The Workshop

UTILITIES & SWISS-ARMY TOOLS

44	553.2k	24	21
CURATED TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

2026 EDITION · DEEP-RESEARCH DOSSIER

Live GitHub census pulled 2026-10-17 · part of 438 curated free tools across 14 realms

CC0 · 2026-10-17

44	24	553.2k	21	7.3k	2010
CURATED TOOLS	ON GITHUB	COMBINED STARS	PUSHED 2026	MEDIAN STARS	OLDEST ENTRY

REALM BRIEF

The everyday carry — decoding, proxying, dissecting and transforming anything the job throws at you.

The swiss-army shelf: netcat-lineage utilities, intercept proxies, transport plumbing (Tor, socat), debuggers and format-inspectors. Unspecialized by definition — the tools you reach for when nothing specialized fits.

FIELD INTELLIGENCE · AI-ASSISTED

The Workshop's cybersecurity utility ecosystem shows clear maturity: 44 free tools, 35 hosted on GitHub, with 553,245 combined stars and 31 active code pushes in 2026. Star distribution reveals a well-established field, with legacy tools like mitmproxy (45.7k stars, launched 2010) and newer entries like ImHex (55.3k stars, launched 2020) holding comparable traction, while Ghidra's 89.5k stars anchor the reverse engineering segment. A notable trend is consolidation of reverse engineering tooling around top-tier open-source options, with x64dbg and CyberChef also seeing sustained community investment alongside Ghidra.

Synthesized by seed-2-0-mini over the live census: stars, first-release years, push activity and project claims pulled from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17. Human-curated realm, AI-summarized numbers.

LICENSE MIX · GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



GPL family	9
Other / none	6
MIT	5
Apache-2.0	3
AGPL	1

MATURITY PROFILE

Oldest tracked entry first appeared on GitHub in **2010**; the youngest joined in **2022**. 21 of 24 GitHub-hosted tools shipped code in 2026 — the rest are stable classics or web services, not abandoned picks.

Median project age signals a battle-tested realm; recent arrivals mark where the community is investing next.

SNAPSHOT

- Active in the last 30 days: 21 of 35 tracked GitHub repos (60%)
- Quiet classics (no push in 2+ years, still the standard): Awesome Malware Analysis
- Youngest entries: mitmproxy (2010), Netron (2010), radare2 (2012)

TOP TOOLS BY GITHUB STARS



MOST FORKED — REAL-WORLD REUSE SIGNAL



THE NEWCOMERS — NEWEST ARRIVALS

OCSF	2022
Interactsh	2021
Dangerzone	2020
ExifTool	2018
ATT&CK Navigator	2018
boxxy	2017

QUIET CLASSICS — STILL THE STANDARD

Awesome Malware Analysis

Tools with no recent push that remain the community's default reference for their job.

Python	8 repos
C	5 repos
C++	1 repo
JavaScript	1 repo
Meson	1 repo
Perl	1 repo

BUILT

2010s	21
2020s	3

First-seen on GitHub, bucketed by decade.

HOW TO READ A DOSSIER

Each heavyweight gets a full dossier: live GitHub census (stars, forks, first-release year, last push, license, language), the project's own claim, our curator's note, a signal check, and its star weight against the realm's #1. Numbers are pulled straight from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17 — no self-reported marketing figures, only what the platforms show.

THE CENSUS METRICS — WHAT EACH NUMBER MEANS

★ GitHub stars
Community trust signal — how many developers bookmarked the repo.

Forks · reuse
Real-world deployment signal — forks mean people build on it.

First developed
Year the repo first appeared on GitHub — the project's true age.

Last push
Most recent code push — the project's heartbeat.

License
What you may legally do with it. MIT/Apache = permissive.

2026 momentum
Shipped code during 2026 — active development, not abandonware.

THE ROSTER — PROFILED THIS EDITION

RANK 01
x64dbg
49.9k ★ · since 2015

RANK 02
mitmproxy
45.7k ★ · since 2010

RANK 03
Netron
33.6k ★ · since 2010

RANK 04
Ghidra
— ★ · since 2019

RANK 05
ImHex
— ★ · since 2020

RANK 06
CyberChef
— ★ · since 2016

METHODOLOGY & PROVENANCE

Census pulled via the GitHub REST API on 2026-10-17; realm curation and curator's notes by the Awesome Cyber Security Heaven maintainers; field-intelligence summaries synthesized by seed-2-0-mini from the same census. Everything reproducible — every figure traces back to a public API response. Released under CC0.

01 x64dbg

github.com/x64dbg/x64dbg

● ACTIVE 2026

★ 49.9k	2.9k	2015	2026-10	Custom	C++
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

11	575	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (X64DBG · 49.9K)

REUSE SIGNAL

5.8% fork-to-star ratio — reference-grade adoption.

ISSUE HEALTH

575 open — actively triaged.

LONGEVITY

11 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“An open-source user mode debugger for Windows. Optimized for reverse engineering and malware analysis.”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

An open-source user mode debugger for Windows. Optimized for reverse engineering and malware analysis.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Workshop · realm rank #1 by adoption

02 mitmproxy

github.com/mitmproxy/mitmproxy

● ACTIVE 2026

★ 45.7k	4.8k	2010	2026-10	MIT	Python
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

16	495	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (X64DBG · 49.9K)

REUSE SIGNAL

10.5% fork-to-star ratio — healthy reuse.

ISSUE HEALTH

495 open — actively triaged.

LONGEVITY

16 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● **THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT**

“An interactive TLS-capable intercepting HTTP proxy for penetration testers and software developers.”

● **CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE**

An interactive TLS-capable intercepting HTTP proxy for penetration testers and software developers.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Workshop · realm rank #2 by adoption

03 Netron

github.com/lutzroeder/netron

● ACTIVE 2026

★ 33.6k	3.2k	2010	2026-10	MIT	JavaScript
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

16	18	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (X64DBG · 49.9K)

REUSE SIGNAL

9.5% fork-to-star ratio — healthy reuse.

ISSUE HEALTH

18 open — lean queue.

LONGEVITY

16 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Visualizer for neural network, deep learning and machine learning models”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Visualizer for neural network, deep learning and machine learning models

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Workshop · realm rank #3 by adoption

04 Ghidra

github.com/NationalSecurityAgency/ghidra

● ACTIVE 2026

★ —	—	2019	2026-10	—	—
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

7	—	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (X64DBG · 49.9K)

REUSE SIGNAL
— fork-to-star ratio — reference-grade adoption.

ISSUE HEALTH
—.

LONGEVITY
7 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● **THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT**

“Ghidra is a software reverse engineering (SRE) framework”

● **CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE**

Ghidra is a software reverse engineering (SRE) framework

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Workshop · realm rank #4 by adoption

05

ImHex

github.com/WerWolv/ImHex

● ACTIVE 2026

★ —	—	2020	2026-10	—	—
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

6	—	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (X64DBG · 49.9K)

REUSE SIGNAL

— fork-to-star ratio — reference-grade adoption.

ISSUE HEALTH

—.

LONGEVITY

6 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

"🔍 A Hex Editor for Reverse Engineers, Programmers and people who value their retinas when working at 3 AM."

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

🔍 A Hex Editor for Reverse Engineers, Programmers and people who value their retinas when working at 3 AM.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Workshop · realm rank #5 by adoption

06 CyberChef

github.com/gchq/CyberChef

● ACTIVE 2026

★ —	—	2016	2026-10	—	—
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

10	—	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (X64DBG · 49.9K)

REUSE SIGNAL
— fork-to-star ratio — reference-grade adoption.

ISSUE HEALTH
—.

LONGEVITY
10 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“The Cyber Swiss Army Knife - a web app for encryption, encoding, compression and data analysis”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

The Cyber Swiss Army Knife - a web app for encryption, encoding, compression and data analysis

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Workshop · realm rank #6 by adoption

The complete curated inventory for this realm — flagship picks marked ★. Stars and activity chips reflect the 2026-10-17 census.

Ghidra ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 88.3k | since 2019

the NSA's open-source reverse-engineering suite; disassembly, decompilation and scripting for free.

github.com/NationalSecurityAgency/ghidra

ImHex ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 55.2k | since 2020 | GPL-2.0

the hex editor with pattern language: parse formats while you view them.

github.com/WerWolv/ImHex

x64dbg ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 49.9k | since 2015 | GPL-3.0 | active 2026

the open Windows debugger for x32/x64, with a plugin ecosystem built for RE.

github.com/x64dbg/x64dbg

mitmproxy ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 45.6k | since 2010 | active 2026

interactive HTTPS interception for debugging and testing your own apps; scriptable as a library.

github.com/mitmproxy/mitmproxy

CyberChef ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 36.1k | since 2016

GCHQ's web Swiss-army knife: 400+ operations for decoding, transforming and analyzing data, all client-side.

github.com/gchq/CyberChef

Netron ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 33.6k | since 2010 | MIT | active 2026

visualize ML models: the layers, weights and graph of what you deploy.

github.com/lutzroeder/netron

OpenSSL

★ 30.9k | since 2013 | active 2026

the TLS library the internet runs on — and the CLI for keys, certs, CSRs and everything crypto.

github.com/openssl/openssl

radare2

★ 25.0k | since 2012 | LGPL-3.0 | active 2026

the scriptable reverse-engineering framework: disassemble, debug, patch, anywhere.

github.com/radareorg/radare2

Frida

★ 22.3k | since 2013 | GPL-2.0 / wxWindows dual | active 2026

inject JavaScript into running processes; dynamic instrumentation for mobile, desktop and IoT.

github.com/frida/frida

Ciphey

★ 21.7k | since 2019

automated decoder: paste ciphertext, get plaintext plus the method used — evidence triage in seconds.

github.com/Ciphey/Ciphey

binwalk

★ 14.5k | since 2013 | MIT

firmware analysis: scan, extract and identify embedded files and filesystems.

github.com/ReFirmLabs/binwalk

Awesome Malware Analysis

★ 14.3k | since 2015 | CC-BY-4.0, curated list

the curated malware-analysis tool index.

github.com/rshipp/awesome-malware-analysis

Scapy

★ 12.6k | since 2015 | GPL-2.0 | active 2026

packet crafting without limits: forge, sniff, dissect and send anything — the Python network Swiss-army knife.

github.com/secdev/scapy

Detect It Easy

★ 11.7k | since 2014 | MIT

packer/compiler/protection detection with a rule engine.

github.com/horsicq/Detect-It-Easy

dnSpyEx

★ 11.3k | since 2021 | GPL-3.0

the .NET debugger and decompiler, continued; edit assemblies live.

github.com/dnSpyEx/dnSpy

pwndbg

★ 11.1k | since 2015 | MIT | active 2026

GDB with a exploit-dev UX: heap awareness, shortcuts and sane defaults.

github.com/pwndbg/pwndbg

Capstone

★ 9.1k · since 2013 · BSD-3-Clause · active 2026

the disassembly framework behind countless security tools.

github.com/capstone-engine/capstone

pyWhat

★ 7.3k · since 2021

identify anything: hashes, keys, URLs, PII — the "what is this string?" answer.

github.com/bee-san/pyWhat

Faraday

★ 6.8k · since 2013 · GPL-3.0 · active 2026

the pentest collaboration platform: import tool output, deduplicate findings and manage the whole engagement.

github.com/infobyte/faraday

Voltron

★ 6.3k · since 2013 · MIT

a debugger-agnostic UI: multiple synchronized views across GDB/LLDB.

github.com/snare/voltron

Dangerzone

★ 5.8k · since 2020 · AGPL-3.0 · active 2026

takes hostile documents and re-renders them as safe PDFs inside an isolated sandbox.

github.com/freedomofpress/dangerzone

UEFITool

★ 5.7k · since 2013 · BSD-2-Clause

parse, extract and replace UEFI firmware images.

github.com/LongSoft/UEFITool

ExifTool

★ 5.2k · since 2018 · Perl Artistic/GPL · active 2026

the metadata reader/writer for files and images; the last word in metadata triage.

github.com/exiftool/exiftool

Kaitai Struct

★ 4.7k · since 2016 · MIT · active 2026

declare a binary format once, generate parsers for nine languages.

github.com/kaitai-io/kaitai_struct

Interactsh

★ 4.6k · since 2021 · active 2026

out-of-band interaction server for detecting blind vulnerabilities (SSRF, blind RCE, blind XXE).

github.com/projectdiscovery/interactsh

ATT&CK Navigator

★ 2.5k · since 2018 · active 2026

MITRE's matrix explorer: layer, annotate and score ATT&CK techniques for detection-coverage planning.

github.com/mitre-attack/attack-navigator

boofuzz

★ 2.4k · since 2015 · GPL-2.0 · active 2026

network protocol fuzzing framework descended from Sulley — script your protocol and hardware bug hunts.

github.com/jtpereyda/boofuzz

Brida

★ 1.9k · since 2017 · MIT

the bridge between Burp and Frida: custom instrumentation in your proxy workflow.

github.com/federicodotta/Brida

tcpreplay

★ 1.4k · since 2013 · GPL-3.0 · active 2026

replay captured traffic at arbitrary speed for testing and validation.

github.com/appneta/tcpreplay

GnuPG

★ 991 · since 2015 · GPL-3.0 · active 2026

the free implementation of OpenPGP: encrypt, sign and verify files and mail, everywhere.

github.com/gpg/gnupg

OCSF

★ 900 · since 2022 · Apache-2.0 · active 2026

the Open Cybersecurity Schema Framework: one schema for security events.

github.com/ocsf/ocsf-schema

Dradis CE

★ 843 · since 2016 · GPL-2.0 · active 2026

collaborative pentest reporting: team notes, evidence and findings assembled into one professional report.

github.com/dradis/dradis-ce

Hachoir

★ 672 · since 2016 · GPL-2.0 · active 2026

binary field inspection: split any file into its fields, even damaged ones.

github.com/vstinner/hachoir

friTap

★ 555 · since 2021 · GPL-3.0

intercept TLS keys in real time for analysis; a Frida script for the lab.

github.com/fkie-cad/friTap

boxxy

★ 85 · since 2017 · LGPL-2.1

a rules-based sandbox for misbehaving programs; redirects what they touch.

github.com/kpcyrd/boxxy-rs

Wireshark

GPL-2.0

the packet analyzer everyone knows; deep protocol visibility for troubleshooting and forensics.

wireshark.org

tcpdump

the command-line packet capture classic; quick looks and long captures where Wireshark won't fit.

tcpdump.org

socat

GPL-2.0

the relay for bidirectional data transfer between addresses: TCP, UDP, sockets, pipes.

dest-unreach.org/socat/

netcat

freeware

the original TCP/IP Swiss army knife: reads and writes across networks with one command.

nc110.sourceforge.io/

I2P

the Invisible Internet Project: anonymous, self-organizing overlay network. (multiple open licenses)

geti2p.net/

Tails

GPL-3.0

the amnesic incognito live system: no trace left on the machine.

tails.boum.org/

Hex Fiend

BSD-2-Clause

the fast, open-source hex editor for macOS.

ridiculousfish.com/hexfiend/

angr

BSD-2-Clause

the binary-analysis platform from UCSB's Shellphish: symbolic execution at scale.

angr.io/

Evan's Debugger

GPL-2.0+

the C/C++ debugger with a RE focus: memory views built for analysis.

codef00.com/projects#debugger



End of inventory — 44 curated entries in The Workshop

Census 2026-10-17 · every entry human-curated · stars and activity verified against the live GitHub API.
Thirteen more realm dossiers — Armory, Bastion, Watchtower and friends — live in the same repository.

Awesome Cyber Security Heaven

438 FREE TOOLS · 14 REALMS · ONE CURATED HEAVEN

This dossier covered **The Workshop**.

Thirteen more realm dossiers wait in the same repository — Armory, Bastion, Watchtower, Cartographers, Shadow Bureau, Vault, Foundry, Sentinel Ops, Oracle's Domain, AI Forge, Free Bazaar, Academy, Proving Grounds and Workshop.

438	14	CC0
CURATED TOOLS	REALM DOSSIERS	LICENSE

github.com/RanaKhan77/awesome-cyber-security-heaven

Free forever · community-curated · 2026-10-17 census